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Documenting the street narrative, the conflict of earth and sky, and the testaments of the immortal.

An independent forum for memory and cultural resistance.

Editorial

Conflict of Earth and Sky: Why the Palestine Cause Cannot Be Understood Apart from Faith

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At cold negotiating tables, politicians speak the language of numbers, land area, population density, and secure borders. They imagine that a pen, paper, and colored maps are enough to divide the land and settle decades of conflict. Yet on the ground—where blood is spilled, homes are demolished, and prayers are whispered beneath the roar of artillery—reality speaks an entirely different language: one that answers not to political geography, but to the geography of faith.



Symbolic Woodcut: Conflict of Earth and Sky — deep roots anchored in stone beneath open heavens *MIDAAN ARCHIVE // ART-01*

The greatest error an outside observer can make is reducing the Palestinian-Israeli conflict to a mere border dispute or a political disagreement over statehood and resources. The truth is deeper and far more entrenched: an existential struggle where scriptural texts intertwine with infantry rifles, and the accounts of prophets mix with United Nations resolutions.

The Torah as a Roadmap: Faith in the Service of Colonialism. To understand the heart of the conflict, one must examine how the Zionist movement employed religious faith as a tool of settler colonialism. Although Zionism's founding figures were avowedly secular, they recognized early on that their project could never take hold without spiritual mobilization.

"A Verse in the Book": Roots in the Islamic Collective Conscience

Conversely, one cannot understand the steadfastness of the Palestinian people without understanding the religious conviction that sustains it. For Palestinians—and for the Arabs and Muslims who stand behind them—Palestine is not a tract of earth that could be compensated elsewhere. It is not merely a homeland in the modern nationalist sense; it is a verse in the Quran.

The Muslim bond with Palestine is textual, spiritual, and non-negotiable, resting on two pillars: first, the belief in the Night Journey and Ascension (al-Isra wal-Miraj), where al-Aqsa Mosque is earth's gateway to heaven and the first Qibla of Islam; second, the duty of Ribat (steadfast vigil), where remaining on this land is understood as continuous guardianship over the frontiers of truth, transforming everyday endurance into an act of worship.

> ***"The Palestinian struggle cannot be reduced to a passing border dispute; it is an existential conflict in which sacred scripture intertwines with infantry rifles."***

The Collapse of Political 'Pragmatism': The dilemma lies in the impossibility of dismantling faith through politics. A politician might concede a percentage of land in exchange for concessions, but how does one surrender sanctities woven into the marrow of human identity?

The Palestinian struggle against the occupation is a war of narratives and identity before it is a war of rifles. While Zionism strains history to manufacture artificial legitimacy, the Palestinian narrative stands rooted like an ancient olive tree, drawing its endurance from an unshakable conviction: that justice is never extinguished by the passage of time, and that the land will ultimately speak the language of its rightful people.